

Vox Populi on CachyOS

Civilization V + Vox Populi via Steam and Proton

Revision 11.3.0

2026-10-04

Vox Populi 5.4.6 (stable)

Protontricks 1.14.1-1

Proton 11.0

CachyOS with native Steam; other distributions in §3

No terminal is needed: the work happens in Steam, your package manager (Shelly on CachyOS; Octopi on systems installed before the April 2026 ISO), the Protontricks and Winetricks windows, the installer's wizard and your file manager.

Work through §4–§6 in order: Steps 1–3 prepare the game, Steps 4–8 install Vox Populi and §6 is the first launch. Every step that writes to disk ends in a **Check**; Step 8 checks the two wizard steps, 6 and 7. **WARNING** marks a common failure, **CRITICAL** a step that decides whether this works at all.

Maintained at github.com/ryanmusante/vox-populi-cachyos; this README and `vox-populi-cachyos.pdf` (print-ready US Letter, with diagrams) carry the same text.

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1 How it works

Vox Populi (VP) is the Community Patch Project's overhaul of Civilization V: Brave New World — a replacement game-core DLL with AI and bug fixes (the Community Patch) plus rebalanced rules and new systems.

Proton is mandatory. Vox Populi ships a Windows game-core DLL that the native Aspyr Linux build cannot load.

The installer is Inno Setup 6 (Installer Version 1.2), a plain Win32 wizard that needs no .NET and renders correctly under Proton.

It asks for two different paths; the second one decides the install:

Wizard page	Resolves to	Receives
Select Destination Location — the Documents path	{userdocs}\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization 5	MODS\ (1) Community Patch MODS\ (2) Vox Populi MODS\ (3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files MODS\ (3b) 43 Civs Community Patch MODS\ (4a) Squads for VP MODS\ (5) Modpack Maker for VP Text\VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
LEAVE AS IS	Under Proton: C:\users\steamuser\Documents\... in the prefix	

Wizard page	Resolves to	Receives
Select the Civilization V folder — custom page, after Setup Type SET THIS ONE	Whatever you enter — the REAL game install, reached through S:\ or Z:\ (Wine maps Z: to /)	Assets\DLC\VPUI (VP setups) Assets\DLC\UI_bc1 (EUI setups) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\Expansion2.Civ5Pkg (replaced) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\Sounds\XML\ MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml

The Documents default is already correct: it resolves inside the prefix, where the Windows build reads mods. On a clean prefix the Civilization V folder page arrives blank; the wizard fills it in from the registry or C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\... only when such a game tree exists inside the prefix.

!

CRITICAL — Aim that page at the real Linux install and nothing needs copying. The wizard refuses a folder without Assets\DLC and all ten DLC folders, so on a clean prefix a wrong path is blocked, not installed. A game tree already inside the prefix — a copied install, say — passes that test, and the UI assets then land where the game never reads them.

Every DLC must be installed, not merely owned. The wizard blocks unless DLC_01-DLC_07, DLC_DeLuxe (Babylon), Expansion (Gods & Kings) and Expansion2 (Brave New World) all exist — in practice the Complete Edition on Civ V 1.0.3.279.

It cleans up after itself. Before writing, it deletes the Documents folder's cache and Text\VPUI_tips_en_us.xml, the game folder's VPUI, UI_bc1, Expansion2.Civ5Pkg and sound XML, and the current VP mod folders. It also removes every legacy folder name back to the CBP/CBO/CSD era, including (4) Civ IV Diplomatic Features, (5) More Luxuries, the (6x) compatibility files, (7a) Promotion Icons for VP and (7b) UI - Promotion Tree for VP. Clear nothing by hand, and expect any edit inside a VP mod folder to be lost at the next install or update.

There is no uninstaller entry (Uninstallable=no). Removal is the **Uninstall all** setup type in the same .exe.

Releases are stable or beta. Each links a release-notes thread titled *New STABLE Version* or *New BETA Version*; 5.4.6 (2026-08-31) is stable.

The install at a glance

Each "Done when" entry repeats that step's check.

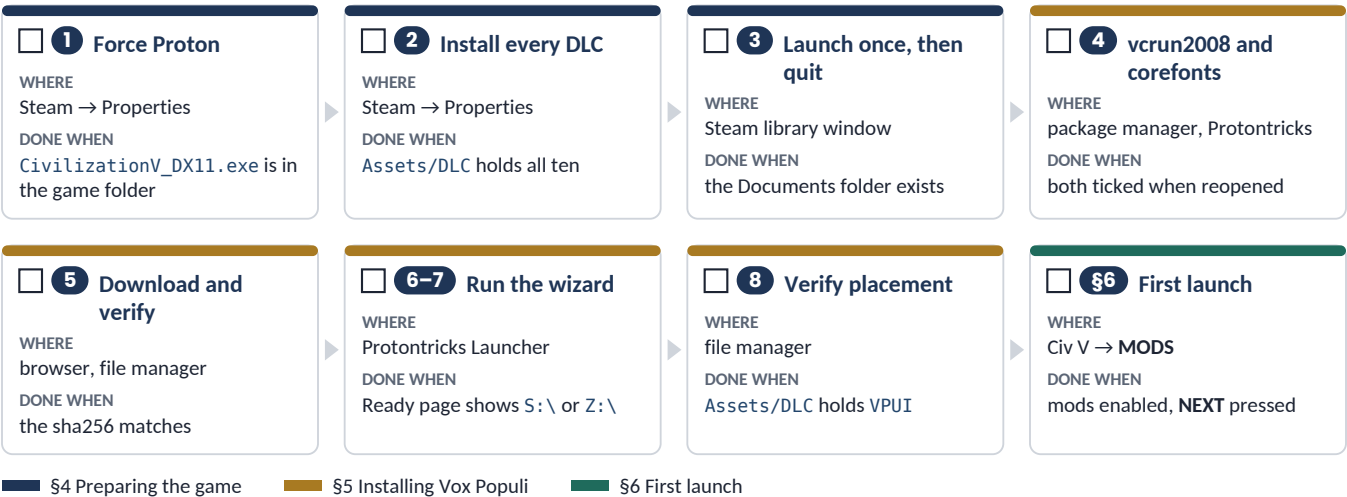


Figure 1 · The install at a glance: tick each box when its check passes; the stripe colour marks the section, as in the key.

2 Requirements

Item	Requirement
Game	Civilization V 1.0.3.279, all expansions and all DLC installed

Item	Requirement
Steam	Native Steam (multilib steam); data directory ~/.local/share/Steam, also reachable through ~/.steam/root. Other distributions: §3
Compat tool	Proton Experimental or newest numbered Proton (11.0 at this revision); proton-cachyos-slr OK. NOT a "Steam Linux Runtime" entry (Step 1)
Language	Game language English (Steam → Properties → Language). VP ships its text in English only; other languages show missing or stale entries
Tooling	extra/protontricks 1.14.1-1 with yad (its game list) and zenity (a Winetricks dialog tool, already a steam dependency); it pulls winetricks, which pulls wine and cabextract
Disk	Full re-download of the Windows depots (the Steam store asks for 8 GB free) plus the 110 MB installer
Conflicts	VP's modinfo files block More Luxuries, CSD for VP, Civ IV Diplomatic Features (both), Artificial Unintelligence, Bridges and Canals, and standalone Squads for VP; remove them, Workshop copies included. No other mod may ship its own DLL

The procedure works in three folders. Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Installed Files** → **Browse** opens the game folder; the library is the folder above steamapps, and compatdata/8930 always sits in the same library as the game. Show hidden files in your file manager — .local and .steam are hidden.

Folder	Location and contents
Steam library	~/.local/share/Steam — native Steam's default on CachyOS; a game in a secondary library uses that library. Other packagings: §3
Game folder	<library>/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V
Documents folder	<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5 — mods, saves, logs, cache and config.ini of the Windows build

LINUX PATH	ROLE AND WHO WRITES IT
/ Z:	Linux root · Wine's Z: drive
~/.local/share/Steam S:	Steam library · S: on Proton 11.0 and Experimental
steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V	Game folder · wizard: Select the Civilization V folder SET THIS ONE
Assets/DLC	VP writes VPUI, UI_bc1, Expansion2.Civ5Pkg, sound XML
steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c C:	Prefix · the prefix's C: drive
users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5	Documents folder · wizard: Select Destination Location LEAVE AS IS
MODS · Text · cache · Saves · Logs · config.ini	mods, tips, cache, saves, logs, settings
✗ Program Files (x86)/Steam/.../Sid Meier's Civilization V	Phantom tree · must not exist (Step 8)

Figure 2 · The three folders, the drive letters Wine maps onto them and the wizard page that writes into each; nothing may land in the phantom tree.

Bookmark the Documents folder in your file manager: §8, §9 and §10 send you back to it to delete cache.

3 Other distributions

Other distributions differ from CachyOS in three things — how Steam is installed, where its default library sits and whether their own Protontricks is recent enough; from Step 1 on, the procedure is the same. **Protontricks 1.12.0 is the floor**: older releases cannot read the current Steam client's appinfo.vdf and stop with "Invalid file magic number".

Distribution	Steam	Protontricks
CachyOS, Arch	steam (multilib)	extra, 1.14.1 — Step 4
Ubuntu 26.04 LTS	steam-installer (multiverse)	multiverse, 1.13.1 — use it
Ubuntu 24.04 LTS	steam-installer (multiverse)	multiverse, 1.10.5 — too old; use the Flatpak

Distribution	Steam	Protontricks
Debian 13	steam-installer (contrib)	none in trixie; use the Flatpak
Fedora 44	steam (RPM Fusion Nonfree)	fedora, 1.13.1 — use it
Steam Deck	preinstalled	Flatpak, from Discover

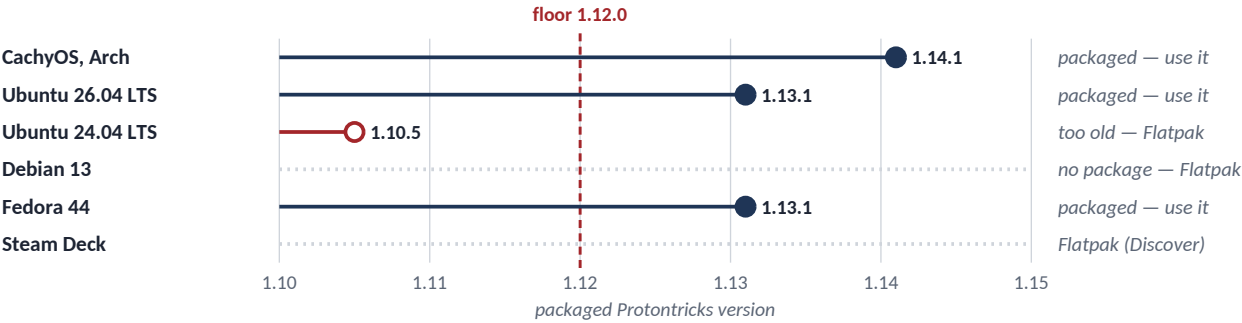


Figure 3 · Protontricks as each distribution packages it, against the 1.12.0 floor; below it or without a package, use the Flatpak.

Where the default library sits — the §2 library unless Civ V lives in a secondary one:

Steam packaging	Default library
Native package, any distro	what <code>~/ .steam/root</code> links to
Arch, CachyOS	<code>~/ .local/share/Steam</code>
Debian, Ubuntu	<code>~/ .steam/debian-installation</code> for a new install; older installs may sit in <code>~/ .local/share/Steam</code>
Flatpak Steam	<code>~/ .var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/ .local/share/Steam</code>
Snap Steam	<code>~/snap/steam/common/ .local/share/Steam</code>

Debian and Ubuntu need the i386 architecture enabled and the `multiverse` (Ubuntu) or `contrib` (Debian) component before `steam-installer` is offered. Debian also wants the 32-bit Mesa packages that the Debian wiki's Steam page lists, or NVIDIA's 32-bit driver libraries (`nvidia-driver-libs:i386`) with the proprietary driver. Fedora takes Steam from RPM Fusion Nonfree and Protontricks from Fedora itself.

Where the table says **Flatpak**, add Flathub, install `com.github.Matoking.protontricks` and restart; on the **Steam Deck**, use Desktop Mode's Discover — SteamOS's root is read-only. Flatpak Protontricks reaches Steam's own directories plus the standard Desktop, Documents, Downloads, Music, Pictures and Videos folders, and ships the same app shortcut and Launcher entries. With a library or installer anywhere else, it names the folders it cannot reach and how to grant access.

Then, on any of them: start Steam once and sign in so it creates its directories, confirm in your package manager that Protontricks is 1.12.0 or newer, and continue with Step 1.

4 Preparing the game

Steps 1–3 switch Civ V to its Windows build under Proton, make sure every DLC is installed and create the Wine prefix.

Step 1 · Force Proton

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Compatibility** → tick **Force the use of a specific Steam Play compatibility tool** → Proton Experimental or the newest numbered Proton. Steam swaps the native build for the Windows depots; let it finish. If the download stops with a disk write error, see §13.

 **WARNING** — The same dropdown lists Steam Linux Runtime entries. They are not Proton: no Wine prefix is created, and Protontricks stops with "Proton installation could not be found!".

proton-cachyos-slr from the CachyOS repositories also works (install it, restart Steam); despite the name it is a Proton build, not one of those entries.

Proton 11.0 and Experimental map `S`: to the game's Steam library, used in Step 7; on Proton 10.0 or older add the launch option `PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 %command%`. If the library root is not writable, `S`: is `steamapps` itself (`S:\common\...`).

✓ **Check:** the game folder holds `CivilizationV_DX11.exe` among other `.exe` files. No `.exe` at all, and a `Civ5XP` binary instead, means Steam is still serving the native build.

Step 2 · Confirm every DLC

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **DLC** → tick every entry.

✓ **Check:** `Assets/DLC` in the game folder holds all ten — `DLC_01`–`DLC_07`, `DLC_DeLuxe`, `Expansion` and `Expansion2`. A missing one stops the installer at Step 7.

Step 3 · Launch once, then quit

Press **Play** in the Steam library window and pick **Play Sid Meier's Civilization V (DirectX 10/11)** from Steam's launch options. The first start takes longer while Proton builds the prefix; wait for the main menu, then quit. This creates the prefix, `compatdata/8930/pfx`, which Protontricks needs, and Civ V's Documents folder inside it.

✓ **Check:** the Documents folder exists and holds `config.ini`.

5 Installing Vox Populi

Steps 4–8 add the runtime libraries, verify the installer, run it inside the prefix and check where it put the files.

Step 4 · Install Protontricks and the runtime libraries

Install `protontricks` and `yad` from the CachyOS repositories; `zenity` is already there as a Steam dependency (other distributions: §3). Then:

1. Open **Protontricks** from the application menu and pick **Sid Meier's Civilization V** — it is listed only after Step 3.
2. In the Winetricks window that opens, choose **Select the default wineprefix**.
3. **Install a Windows DLL or component** → tick `vcrun2008` → **OK**.
4. **Install a font** → tick `corefonts` → **OK**, then close Winetricks.

Close the 64-bit WINEPREFIX warning: every Proton prefix is 64-bit. Both installs download; repeating the step is harmless.

`vcrun2008` is the Visual C++ 2008 runtime the VP game-core DLL imports; Wine's built-in copy usually suffices, but a report in [thread 702075](https://forums.civfanatics.com/threads/702075) (forums.civfanatics.com/threads/702075) needed it. `corefonts` adds the Microsoft core fonts.

✓ **Check:** opened again, those two lists show `vcrun2008` and `corefonts` already ticked.

Step 5 · Download and verify

Download `Vox.Populi.<version>.exe` from the release's assets at github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/releases; the asset list shows each file's digest. `Release_Debug.zip` beside it is a debug DLL for crash reports, not needed for play. For 5.4.6:

Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe — 110,481,637 bytes
sha256 31679423e55d7f64ba9693d8252d9e29f824fd9f8da043af547470068f98ba8a

✓ **Check:** the digest your file manager computes matches (Dolphin: **Properties** → **Checksums**). On a mismatch, delete the file and download it again.

Step 6 • Run the installer inside the prefix

Right-click `Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe` → **Open With** → **Protontricks Launcher** → **Sid Meier's Civilization V**. The wizard can take a minute to appear and may open behind other windows under Wayland.

Step 7 • Complete the wizard

The actions in capitals decide the result:

Wizard page	Action
License • Information	Accept the agreement, then Next on both
Select Destination Location	LEAVE UNCHANGED . It must read <code>C:\users\steamuser\Documents\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization 5</code>
Setup Type / Components	CHOOSE one setup type — table below
Select the Civilization V folder	TYPE <code>S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V</code> , or the <code>Z:\</code> form of the game folder given below
Ready to Install	CHECK that "Civilization V path" shows the <code>S:\</code> or <code>Z:\</code> path, not <code>C:\Program Files (x86)\...</code>
Installing • Finished	Wait, then Finish

The setup types, in the installer's order:

Setup type	What it installs
Vox Populi (with EUI)	Full VP + Enhanced User Interface — the usual choice
Vox Populi (no EUI)	Full VP, stock interface
Community Patch only	AI and bug-fix base mod. NOT compatible with EUI
43 Civ Community Patch only, 43 Civ Vox Populi (no EUI), 43 Civ Vox Populi (with EUI)	The same three with a DLL supporting 43 major civs
Uninstall all	Removal — §12

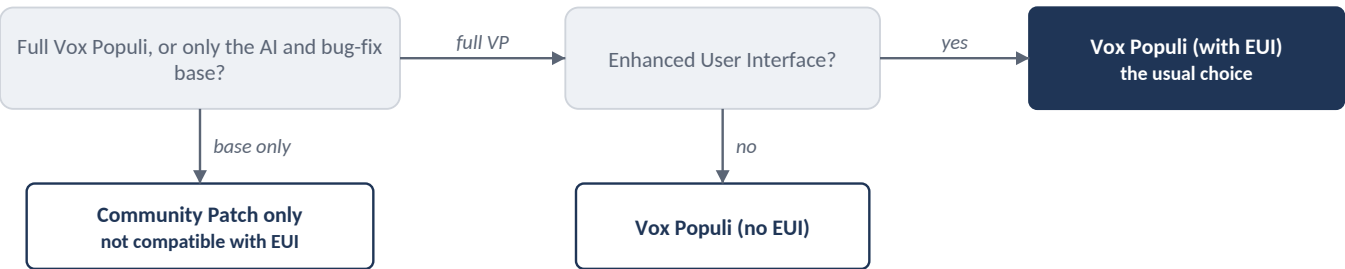


Figure 4 • Choosing the setup type. For 43 major civs take the 43 Civ version of the same type; Uninstall all removes VP (§12).

The `Z:\` form of the game folder in the default library:

`Z:\home\<your user name>\.local\share\Steam\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V`

Step 8 • Verify placement

✓ **Check:** `Assets/DLC` in the game folder now holds `VPUI`, plus `UI_bc1` with EUI — the pass/fail test for Step 7. **Community Patch only** installs neither but still adds `Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml` there. The Documents folder's `MODS` holds the numbered mod folders of your variant.

If <library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V exists, the files went into the prefix: re-run with the correct path, or copy that tree's Assets over the game folder's.

6 First launch

1. Launch Civ V from the Steam library window, as in Step 3.
2. Main menu → **MODS**; accept the prompt if one appears.
3. The first entry into the MODS menu runs a "configuring game data" pass of 5–15 minutes — not a hang; if it crashes, relaunch (§13).
4. Enable the VP mods the installer placed in **MODS** — the table below.
5. Press **NEXT**, never **Back**.
6. **Single Player** → **Set Up Game**. In this menu *Single Player* looks like a heading but is a button.

Mod	When to enable it
(1) Community Patch	Always — every other VP mod requires it
(2) Vox Populi	Requires (1) Community Patch
(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files	MUST be on for any EUI install
(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch	Only for 43-civ variants
(4a) Squads for VP	Optional: RTS-style control groups (quality of life)
(5) Modpack Maker for VP	Leave off for normal play; builds modpacks (§10)

 **CRITICAL** — Back returns to the main menu and silently deactivates the mod set — the most common "I installed VP and nothing changed" report.

 **Check:** after **NEXT** the menu lists the enabled mods; missing VP units or wrong text: §13.

7 Settings and stability

Recommended settings

Setting	Single player	Multiplayer
Autosave frequency	1 turn	1 turn
Max autosaves	0 (unlimited)	500
Leader Scene Quality	Minimum	Minimum
Yield icons	Off from the Industrial era	Off from the Industrial era — every player must do it

Single-player values follow the install thread and the bug-report form; the modpack thread asks for 500 autosaves in multiplayer. The aim is a save from the turn *before* a problem, which needs frequent autosaves that are never rotated away.

Crashes

Late-game crashes are a memory problem, not a Vox Populi bug. Civ V is 32-bit, and the project attributes most late-game CTDs (crashes to desktop) to address-space exhaustion. Mitigations, most important first:

1. Leader Scene Quality on Minimum.
2. Yield icons off from the Industrial era, or avoid zooming far out.
3. Standard or small maps.

4. A lower in-game resolution — ultrawide and 4K panels are the demanding case.

Proton already helps: `PROTON_FORCE_LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE` is **on by default**, giving the 32-bit executable a 4 GB address space instead of 2 GB; leave it alone. Upstream tracks the same picture in #13344 (crash, likely out of memory) and the draft fix #13372 (intermittent crashes loading huge maps).

Early, random crashes are a different problem. ProtonDB reports tie them to thread count. Under Proton the reported fix is the launch option `taskset -c 0-7 %command%` (**Properties → General → Launch Options**), which pins the game to eight threads. One reporter instead raised `MaxSimultaneousThreads` in the Documents folder's `config.ini` (default 8) to the machine's thread count; another found that 24 stopped the game from starting. Reports that edit that key under `~/.local/share/Aspyr` concern the native build; Proton never reads that file.



Figure 5 · Crash triage by when the crash happens: each card gives the cause, the fix and the section that explains it.

Performance and configuration files

Late-game turn times are AI-bound, not GPU-bound. Treat graphics settings as a memory lever rather than a frame-rate one, and cap the frame rate at the panel's refresh rate with VSync.

The game keeps its settings as plain-text `.ini` files in the Documents folder (§2) — under Proton, inside the prefix. Edit them with the game closed; the in-game menus write to the same files, and deleting them resets every setting to default at the next start.

File	What it holds
<code>config.ini</code>	Debugging, logging (§15), audio switches and startup parameters — <code>MaxSimultaneousThreads</code> (above) lives here
<code>UserSettings.ini</code>	User options — <code>SkipIntroVideo</code> , <code>NoBasicHelp</code> , <code>DisableAdvisorSpeech</code> and <code>AutoWorkersDontReplace</code> among them
<code>GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini</code>	Everything from Options → Video for the DX11 build: resolution, fullscreen, VSync, MSAA, the detail levels
<code>GraphicsSettingsDX9.ini</code>	The same for the DX9 build — each build keeps its own

The table pairs each Options → Video setting with its key in `GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini` and a performance-first value. Forum benchmarks single out anti-aliasing and terrain tessellation; the rest are ordinary detail levels.

Options → Video	Key	Performance-first
Anti-Aliasing	<code>MSAASamples</code>	Off (1). Costliest item; DX11 AA can also black out the screen
VSync	<code>WaitForVSync</code>	On (1). Caps at the refresh rate, steadies frame times
Leader Scene Quality	—	Minimum — saves memory
Terrain Tessellation Level	<code>TerrainTessLevel</code> , <code>BicubicTerrainTessSubdiv</code>	Low. On a weak GPU also set <code>BicubicTerrainTessSubdiv 0</code>
Shadow Detail · Terrain Shadow Quality	<code>ShadowLevel</code> , <code>TerrainShadowQuality</code>	Low
Water Quality · reflections	<code>TerrainWaterQuality</code> , <code>ReflectionLevel</code>	Low · off
High Detail Strategic View	<code>HDStrategicView</code>	Off (0)

Options → Video	Key	Performance-first
Overlay Detail · Fog of War · Terrain Detail Level	OverlayLevel, FOWLevel, TerrainDetailLevel	Low
Texture Quality	TextureQuality	High, unless late-game crashes point at memory

Two fixes exist only in the files. `MinimizeGrayTiles = 1` in the graphics file stops the gray tiles that appear while scrolling on weaker GPUs (the official Steam FAQ's fix). `FullScreen`, `WindowResX` and `WindowResY` under `[UserSettings]` in the graphics file recover a game that opens at a size the screen cannot show; the DX11 build needs at least 768 pixels of height. `SkipIntroVideo = 1` in `UserSettings.ini` is the file form of the in-game *Skip Intro* option; the movie plays while the game loads, so skipping it leaves a black screen rather than saving time. For wall-clock time rather than frame rate, turn on **Quick Combat** and **Quick Movement** under Options → Game.

8 Community Patch options

The options file is `MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml` in the Documents folder. Its header sets three rules:

- An option with a "**See also:**" comment is enabled through its mod, not here.
- One listing "**Defines:**" or "**PostDefines:**" needs those defines verified first.
- Anything else is enabled by changing `Value` from 0 to 1.

A row's `Class` (0 Data ... 6 Major) describes what kind of option it is, not how safe it is. Leave `Class` 3, Events, alone unless you need it: those options run game-core triggers whether or not anything consumes them. The four options most people want:

Option	Effect
<code>ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS</code>	Steam achievements in modded single player. Marked " FUNCTIONALITY NOT GUARANTEED " and it changes the savegame format — set it before a campaign, not during
<code>DIPLO_DEBUG_MODE (+ ..._SETTING)</code>	Reveals the AI's true opinion, approach and Congress voting; at setting 2 the AI accepts every Discuss request
<code>SQLITE_LOGGING</code>	Writes gameplay statistics to a queryable <code>stats.db</code>
<code>CORE_DEBUGGING</code>	Extra game-core debugging; slows the game, leave off

Delete cache after editing, and keep a copy of the file — the installer rewrites these folders on every update. Use `ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS` rather than the executable-patching method used for other modded Civ V setups; map-type achievements are broken on the native Linux build regardless of mods, but work under Proton.

9 Adding other mods

Rules for every added mod

- Any mod that ships its own DLL is incompatible. VP replaces the Civ V DLL entirely, and the Community Patch cannot coexist with another DLL mod.
- VP reworks most systems: anything beyond maps, civilizations, art or interface needs a version made for VP.
- Steam Workshop subscriptions do not reliably land in the right place under Proton. Download from CivFanatics or GitHub and extract manually.
- Mods go in the Documents folder's **MODS** — inside the prefix, beside the VP folders.
- After **ANY** mod change, delete `cache` and `ModUserData` there before launching. Stale cache is the most common reason mods look broken.
- Filenames do not need lowercasing under Proton; that applies to the native build.

Where compatible mods live

Mods for VP are posted in the Community Patch Project's **Mods Repository** (forums.civfanatics.com/forums/549) subforum (Civ5 → Creation & Customization → Project & Mod Development → Community Patch Project). Its sticky [Mod Compatibility with Latest Version](https://forums.civfanatics.com/threads/701787) (forums.civfanatics.com/threads/701787) (January 2026) says every mod there is meant to work with the current VP and asks for problem reports, with logs, in each mod's thread. Mods that stop working move to the **Mods Archive**. A thread's opening post holds the download — an attachment, a file-host link or a GitHub repository — and its last pages hold the reports for 5.4.6. Copies in the site's **Downloads** section and on the Steam Workshop can lag by years: Even More Resources' Workshop page carries reports that it fails on VP 3.1.1.

The older list [MODS compatible with Vox Populi \(VP\)](https://forums.civfanatics.com/threads/542679) (forums.civfanatics.com/threads/542679) was last edited in March 2022, before VP 5, and now sits in the forum's archive.

Most downloaded VP-only mods

The table lists mods made only for Vox Populi that show 2026 activity and no reported breakage, ranked by their CivFanatics download counters on 2026-10-04. Versions are as the authors state them; "thread active 2026" means 2026 posts but no stated VP version. More Unique Components (54,804 downloads) is left out because it is part of VP 5, and Promotion Overhaul for VP (12,048) because its current version targets VP 5.2.x.

Mod and author	What it adds	Downloads, status
City-States Leaders for VP by adan_eslavo	Leaders for city-states	10,175; v26, VP 5.3.x; made for Unique City-States
Unique City-States by adan_eslavo	Unique traits for city-states	6,664; v19.3, VP 5.4.x
Wonder Planner for VP by adan_eslavo	Planning screen for wonders	5,723; v20
Better Lakes for VP by InkAxis	Lake rework	5,186; thread active 2026
Unit Scaling and Formation for VP by N.Core	Unit model size and formations	3,291; thread active 2026

Installing a mod

1. Download from the opening post, not the Steam Workshop (see the rules above).
2. Extract the archive. A `.civ5mod` is a 7-Zip archive under another name; rename it to `.7z` if your archiver refuses it. The game can unpack a `.civ5mod` left in MODS when the MODS menu opens, but the forum reports that as hit-or-miss, so extract it yourself.
3. Move the folder that contains the `.modinfo` file straight into the Documents folder's **MODS**, beside the numbered VP folders — not the archive, not a folder inside a folder. Many mods carry a prefix such as **(7a)** so they sort after VP's own entries.
4. Opening posts give Windows paths. One under `steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V` means the real game folder (§2), never a `C:\Program Files (x86)` tree inside the prefix (Step 8).
5. Delete `cache` and `ModUserData`.
6. In the MODS menu, enable the VP set first, then the new mod, then press **NEXT**. The mod lists what it requires: nearly all need (1) and (2).

Add one mod at a time and play a few turns before the next, so a crash points at the last one added (§13). For multiplayer the mod must be part of the modpack (§10); a mod enabled through the menu cannot join a modpack game.

10 Multiplayer

VP cannot be played in multiplayer through the MODS menu; it must be packaged as a modpack that loads automatically as a DLC.

Preferred — a prebuilt modpack. The CivFanatics [modpack thread 685164](https://forums.civfanatics.com/threads/685164) (forums.civfanatics.com/threads/685164) tracks current releases (5.4.6), including one generated on Linux under Proton. Extract so its folders — `ZMP_MODPACK` and any `VPUI` or `UI_bc1` it carries — sit directly under the game folder's `Assets/DLC`, then delete the Documents folder's `cache`. Modpacks also work in single player and are easier to update than a MODS-menu install.

Alternative — build your own with the Modpack Maker:

1. Turn logging on (§15), then enable (5) `Modpack Maker` for VP plus every mod to include.
2. Start or load a game and press **Ctrl+Shift+M**.
3. Check `Logs/Lua.log` in the Documents folder for errors.
4. Exit and delete `cache`.
5. Relaunch and start from Single Player or Multiplayer, never the MODS menu.

Alternative — civ5vp-installer. It builds modpacks too (§14).

Modpack rules

- Modpacks cannot be combined with mods activated through the **MODS** menu
- Every player must use byte-identical modpacks
- Every player must delete `cache` **BEFORE EVERY LAUNCH**, or the game will most likely crash after the first turn
- Do not hand-edit a modpack folder — rebuild or re-download it instead
- Saves do not record which modpack was used; a mismatch crashes
- Multiplayer autosaves live in `Saves/multi/auto` — collect them for desync reports

Remove a modpack by deleting its folders under `Assets/DLC` and the Documents folder's `cache`: `VP_MODPACK` for one you built; `ZMP_MODPACK`, `VPUI` and `UI_bc1` for the thread's packs, per its opening post.

Known issues. Community-Patch-DLL #13349, open since 2026-09-05, reports a 5.4.x multiplayer desync that its reporter suspects lies in pathfinding; check its state before a long game. MPPatch, which would allow modded multiplayer without modpacks, has had no release since December 2023, and a forum report describes crashes with VP plus EUI.

11 Updating

Back up first: copy `Saves` and `MODS` from the Documents folder to somewhere outside the prefix. A prefix reset destroys the saves, and the installer rewrites the mod folders, losing any edit under `MODS`.

Then download the newer `Vox.Populi.<version>.exe`, check it against its own digest on the release page (Step 5) and run it exactly as in Steps 6–7. It deletes the old mod folders and `cache` before writing; no manual cleanup.

By the project's versioning rule, saves are compatible when only the third version component changes: 5.4.4 → 5.4.6 keeps them, 5.4.x → 5.5.0 does not.

⚠ WARNING — Steam's *Verify integrity of game files* restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`, which VP replaces to fix city-state audio. Re-run the VP installer after any verify.

12 Uninstalling

Preferred — Uninstall all. Re-run the installer, choose **Uninstall all** and point the Civilization V folder page at the same real install; this also restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`.

Fallback — manual removal. Delete these, then verify game files in Steam to restore the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg` — verification leaves added files alone, hence the sound XML in the list:

Folder	Delete
Documents folder	MODS/(1) Community Patch · MODS/(2) Vox Populi MODS/(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files MODS/(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch · MODS/(4a) Squads for VP MODS/(5) Modpack Maker for VP cache · ModUserData · Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
Game folder	Assets/DLC/VPUI · Assets/DLC/UI_bc1 Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK or Assets/DLC/ZMP_MODPACK (modpacks, §10) Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml

Last resort — prefix reset. Delete `<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930`; this also destroys the saves inside the prefix, so back them up first (§11).

13 Troubleshooting

The tables are ordered by when the failure appears.

Setup and install

Symptom	Cause and fix
Steam: "disk write error" while it downloads the Windows depots (Step 1)	Steam bug with case-mismatched depot folders (steam-for-linux #13406, fixed 2026-07-27). Update Steam; else create the folder the error names, in that exact case, under <code>steamapps/downloading/8930</code> .
"Invalid file magic number"	Protontricks older than 1.12.0. Upgrade, or use the Flatpak (§3).
Flatpak: "does not appear to have access to the following directories"	The file or library is outside the Flatpak's folders (§3): move it or grant access as the message says.
Protontricks does not list Civ V	Prefix absent. Launch once via Proton (Step 3).
"Proton installation could not be found!"	A Steam Linux Runtime entry is selected, not Proton. Pick Proton (Step 1).
"command cabextract ... returned status 1"	cabextract trips over a symlink Proton created. Delete the symlink the error names, then re-run.
Wizard never appears	Check other windows (Wayland focus), then try Proton Experimental.
"did not provide the correct path"	The folder has no <code>Assets\ DLC</code> child. Point at the game root, not Assets or DLC.
"You don't have all required DLCs"	The message names the missing packs. Install them (Step 2).

In the game

Symptom	Cause and fix
Crash during the first "configuring game data" pass	Seen once in thread 702075: relaunch and enter MODS again (§6); if it repeats, delete cache.
VP absent from the in-game mod list	The Documents page was changed; mods are outside the prefix. Re-run with the default path.
Missing textures, broken UI	The Civ V folder page pointed into the prefix. Re-run, or copy across per Step 8.
EUI works, no other VP features	Back was pressed in MODS , or (3a) is off on an EUI install. Enable all mods, press NEXT .

Symptom	Cause and fix
Tech or policy tree unchanged, or entries show wrong text	Game language is not English. Steam → Properties → Language → English, then delete cache (§2).
Mods stale, duplicated or missing	Delete cache and ModUserData (§9); look for Workshop copies sharing mod IDs, or a mod with its own DLL.
CustomModOption change has no effect	Cache not cleared, or the option needed its defines (§8).
Random crashes early in a session	Thread count: pin eight threads with taskset, or set MaxSimultaneousThreads (§7).
Multiplayer crashes after turn 1	A player did not delete cache before launch (§10).
Crash to desktop in the late game	The 32-bit address space ran out. Apply §7 in order; keep crashlogs for a report (§15).
Still broken after all of the above	Minimal install — VP without EUI, no other mods — then add one layer at a time.

14 Alternative installer

github.com/Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer is a single-file native Linux binary (Apache-2.0) that installs VP without Protontricks — a fallback if the Inno wizard misbehaves, newer and less tested than the Protontricks route. It finds the Civ V folders itself (you can correct them), writes only to the game's MODS, DLC and Text folders and its own `~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer`, has a modpack mode, and its Uninstall button restores an unmodded game. The game itself still runs under Proton (§1).

civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64 (v0.1.6, 2026-09-15) — 44,735,720 bytes
sha256 a0b59eb445d23bc9a5206ec0f592a7f81c4cfd40a5f2e0d823737bacbd271baa

Verify the digest as in Step 5, mark the file executable (Dolphin: **Properties → Permissions → Is executable**) and open it.

⚠ WARNING — Install release versions only. On 2026-08-26 the author advised against its "Compile the DLL myself" option, single player included: its compiler can produce a DLL that freezes the game.

15 Bug reporting

Vox Populi bugs go to the project's tracker, github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/issues, not the forum; errors in this guide go to github.com/ryanmusante/vox-populi-cachyos/issues. Upstream's bug form is the only route (blank issues are disabled). It requires the mod version, the installed components — the setup type from Step 7 — and a description, and asks for three attachments:

Attachment	Where it is
Save from one turn before the problem	Saves in the Documents folder — the reason for the autosave settings in §7
Logs	Logs in the Documents folder, zipped — useless unless logging was already on
Crash artifacts, when reporting a crash	crashlogs in the game folder (<code>crashes.log</code> , <code>.dmp</code>) per the issue form; the minidump guide says <code>CvMiniDump_*.dmp</code> beside the game executable — check both

Logging is off by default and must be on *before* the problem occurs: in the Documents folder's `config.ini`, set `ValidateGameDatabase`, `LoggingEnabled`, `MessageLog`, `AILog`, `AIPerfLog`, `BuilderAILog` and `PlayerAndCityAILogSplit` to 1. Collect logs *before* loading a game — most are erased on load — and turn logging off afterwards.

Dumps are not guaranteed under Proton: the DLL loads `dbghelp.dll` from the prefix's `System32`, so it depends on Wine's implementation. If none appears after a crash, say so in the report and attach the logs and save.

16 Path reference

The table lists every location the guide uses, by folder. <library> is the §2 Steam library; indented rows sit inside the row above.

Location	Path
Steam library	~/.local/share/Steam by default, also ~/.steam/root; other packagings in §3
Game folder	<library>/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V
As the wizard sees it	S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V, or its Z:\ form (Step 7)
DLC folders	Assets/DLC/DLC_01–DLC_07, DLC_Deluxe, Expansion, Expansion2 — all ten required (Step 2)
VP assets	Assets/DLC/VPUI · Assets/DLC/UI_bc1 (EUI setups) · Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Expansion2.Civ5Pkg · Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml
Modpack	Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK if built; Assets/DLC/ZMP_MODPACK if prebuilt (§10)
Prefix	<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx
C: drive	pfx/drive_c
Phantom tree (Step 8)	drive_c/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V — must not exist
Documents folder	drive_c/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5
Mods	MODS — the numbered VP folders and any added mod (§6, §9)
Options file	MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml (§8)
Caches	cache · ModUserData — delete after any mod change (§9)
Saves	Saves · Saves/multi/auto for multiplayer autosaves (§10)
Logs	Logs — most files only with logging on (§15)
Settings	config.ini · UserSettings.ini · GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini · GraphicsSettingsDX9.ini (§7)
civ5vp-installer data	~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer (§14)

17 Limits

- **Written against 5.4.6.** Wizard pages and setup-type names have been stable but are not guaranteed; the sha256 is for 5.4.6 only.
- **Read from source, not exercised:** the S: drive default, the Protontricks and Winetricks window routes and the §8 toggles; `ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS` is marked "FUNCTIONALITY NOT GUARANTEED" upstream.
- **Community reports, not upstream statements:** the English-language requirement, the runtime-library step in Step 4, the ProtonDB fixes in §7 and §13, and the 2010–2013 Windows benchmarks behind §7's performance values.
- **The mod list is a 2026-10-04 snapshot** of CivFanatics download counters; none was tested under Proton, and a mod's last forum page is the authority for 5.4.6.
- **Untested:** the §3 distributions (checked against package listings only), file managers other than KDE's Dolphin, Flatpak and Snap Steam, the 43-civ variants, MPPatch and civ5vp-installer's local DLL build.